Food Inventory

USDA SNAP Store Visits

Objectives

- Key Terms
- Staple Food Groups
- Varieties of Food
- Multiple Ingredient foods
- Stocking Units - Counting Units of Staple Foods
- FFR (Fresh, Frozen, Refrigerated)
- Accessory / non-staple foods and other Foods not counted as Staple Foods
- Priority of food counts
- Counting and Reporting Staple Food Inventory

Key Terms

Staple foods
- Basic foods that make up a significant portion of one's diet
- Usually prepared at home and eaten as a meal

Variety
- Different kinds of food in each of the four staple food groups
- Usually defined by product type or the main ingredient

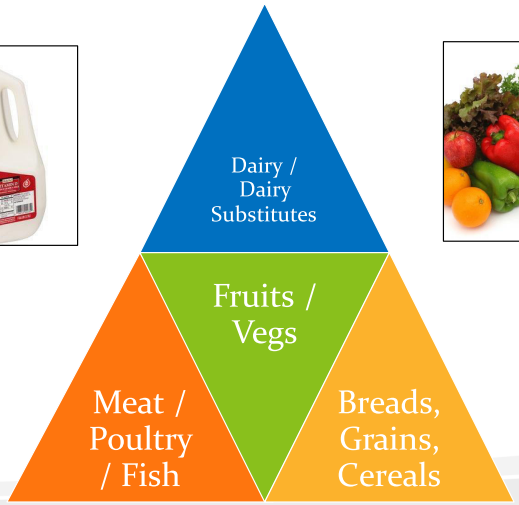
Multiple Ingredient Foods
- Processed/prepared foods with multiple ingredients
- Counted with Staple Foods if the first (main) ingredient is a staple food or if 1st ingredient is water or broth and 2nd ingredient is a staple food

Stocking Units
- Packages in which food is usually sold
- Unpackaged food sold by the pound is counted as 1 pound = 1 stocking unit

FFR (Fresh, Frozen, Refrigerated)
- Foods with short shelf life or refrigerated or frozen
- Each food variety should be marked if it has one or more units of FFR food

Accessory food items
- Foods that complement or supplement meals
- Eligible for purchase on EBT/SNAP, but are not counted with staple food

Staple Food Groups



Varieties of Food

Each Staple Food Group is made up of many varieties (common examples below)

Breads/Cereals
- Loaf Bread
- Buns/Rolls
- Cold Breakfast Cereal (Corn, Oat, Rice, Wheat-based)
- Corn Meal
- Pasta
- Rice
- Tortillas
- Flour

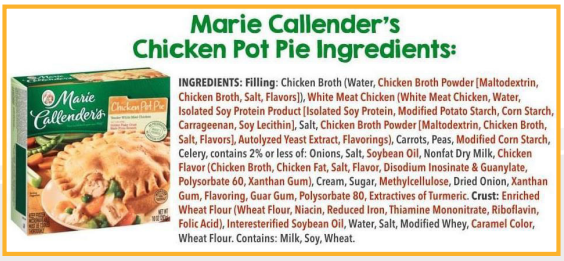
Dairy/Dairy Substitutes
- Butter
- Margarine
- Cheese
- Infant Formula
- Coconut Milk
- Milk
- Sour Cream
- Yogurt

Meats/Poultry/Fish
- Beef
- Chicken
- Eggs
- Pork
- Sardines
- Tuna
- Turkey

Fruits/Vegetables
- Apples
- Bananas
- Grapes/Raisins
- Oranges
- Beans
- Cucumbers/Pickles
- Nuts/Seeds
- Tomatoes

Multiple Ingredient Foods

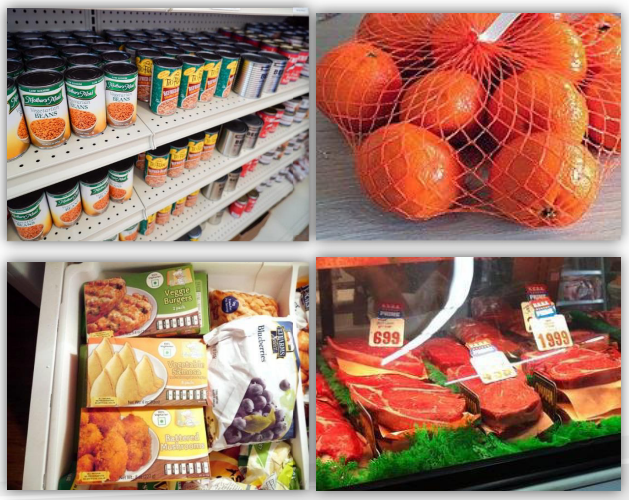
- Processed foods with multiple ingredients
- Should be counted as staple foods if the main (first) ingredient is a staple food
- If the main ingredient is water or broth, and the second ingredient is a staple food, count as in that staple food variety
- For beverages, ONLY 100% juices should be counted



Stocking Units

Food Inventory is counted based on units as purchased by customers

- Bags
- Cans
- Other packaging
- By the pound



FFR (Fresh, Frozen, Refrigerated)

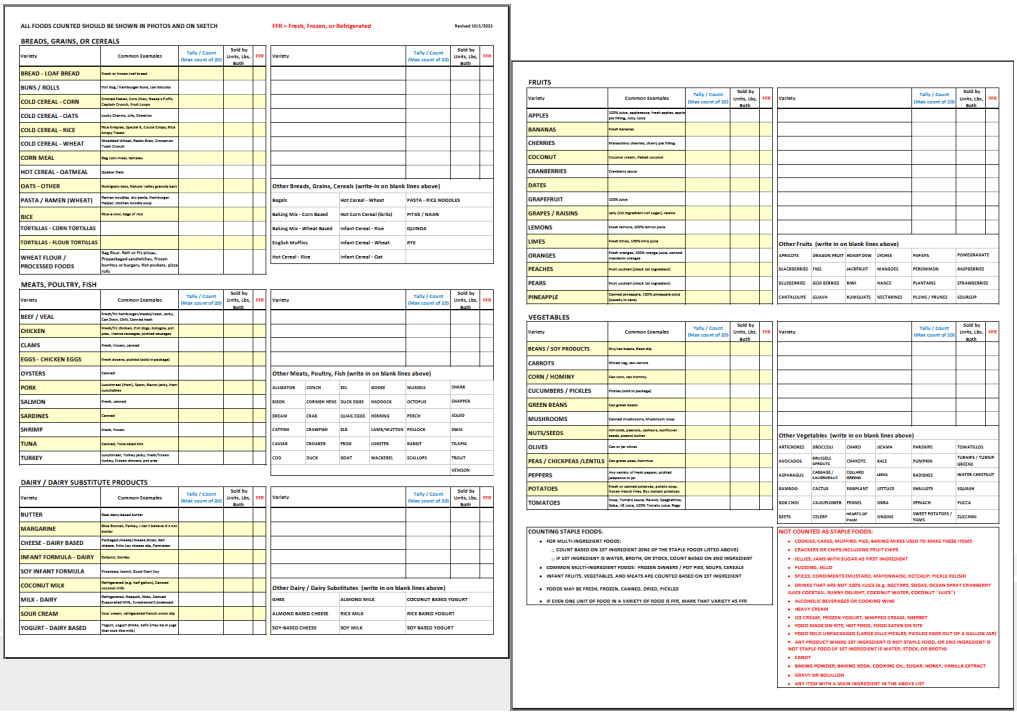
If even one unit of food in a variety is FFR, that variety is marked as having FFR

Fresh – room temperature foods with a short shelf life (2-3 weeks)

Frozen

Refrigerated

Food Inventory



ALL FOODS COUNTED SHOULD BE SHOWN IN PHOTOS AND ON SKETCH — FFR = Fresh, Frozen, or Refrigerated — Revised 02/1/2021

BREADS, GRAINS, OR CEREALS

Variety	Common Examples	Tally / Count (Max count of 20)	Sold by Units, Lbs, Both	FFR
BREAD - LOAF BREAD	Fresh or frozen loaf bread			
BUNS / ROLLS	Hot dog / hamburger buns, can biscuits			
COLD CEREAL - CORN	Kinnikinnick Kidzbar, Corn Chips, Reese's Puffs, Captain Crunch, Fruit Loops			
COLD CEREAL - OATS	Lucky Charms, Life, Cheerios			
COLD CEREAL - RICE	Rice Krispies, Special K, Cocoa Crisps, Rice Krispy Treats			
COLD CEREAL - WHEAT	Shredded Wheat, Raisin Bran, Cinnamon Toast Crunch			
CORN MEAL	Bag corn meal, Jarrodes			
HOT CEREAL - OATMEAL	Quaker Oats			
OATS - OTHER	Nutrigrain bars, Nature Valley granola bars			
PASTA / RAMEN (WHEAT)	Ramen noodles, dry pasta, Hamburger Helper, chicken noodle soup			
RICE	Rice-a-roni, bags of rice			
TORTILLAS - CORN TORTILLAS				
TORTILLAS - FLOUR TORTILLAS				
WHEAT FLOUR / PROCESSED FOODS	Bag flour, Ruff or Pie pizzas, Prepackaged sandwiches, Frozen Stuffins or Burgers, Hot pockets, pizza rolls			

Variety	Tally / Count (Max count of 20)	Sold by Units, Lbs, Both	FFR

Other Breads, Grains, Cereals (write-in on blank lines above)

Bagels	Hot Cereal - Wheat	PASTA - RICE NOODLES
Baking Mix - Corn Based	Hot Corn Cereal (Grits)	PITAS / NAAN
Baking Mix - Wheat Based	Infant Cereal - Rice	QUINOA
English Muffins	Infant Cereal - Wheat	RYE
Hot Cereal - Rice	Infant Cereal - Oat	

MEATS, POULTRY, FISH

Variety	Common Examples	Tally / Count (Max count of 20)	Sold by Units, Lbs, Both	FFR
BEEF / VEAL	Steak/Tri tips/burger/meatballs/roast, Jerky, Can Beef, Chili, Canned hash			
CHICKEN	Steak/Tri chicken, Hot dogs, bologna, pot pies, Vienna sausages, pickled sausages			
CLAMS	Fresh, Frozen, canned			
EGGS - CHICKEN EGGS	Fresh dozens, pickled (sold in package)			
OYSTERS	Canned			
PORK	Lunchmeat (Ham), Spam, Bacon jerky, Ham Sandwiches			
SALMON	Fresh, canned			
SARDINES	Canned			
SHRIMP	Steak, frozen			
TUNA	Canned, Tuna salad kits			
TURKEY	Lunchmeat, Turkey jerky, Fresh/Frozen turkey, Frozen dinners, pot pies			

Variety	Tally / Count (Max count of 20)	Sold by Units, Lbs, Both	FFR

Other Meats, Poultry, Fish (write in on blank lines above)

ALLIGATOR	CONCH	EEL	GOOSE	MUSSELS	SHARK
BISON	CORNISH HENS	DUCK EGGS	HADDOCK	OCTOPUS	SNAPPER
BREAM	CRAB	QUAIL EGGS	HERRING	PERCH	SQUID
CATFISH	CRAWFISH	ELK	LAMB/MUTTON	POLLOCK	EMU
CAVIAR	CROAKER	FROG	LOBSTER	RABBIT	TILAPIA
COD	DUCK	GOAT	MACKEREL	SCALLOPS	TROUT
					VENISON

DAIRY / DAIRY SUBSTITUTE PRODUCTS

Variety	Common Examples	Tally / Count (Max count of 20)	Sold by Units, Lbs, Both	FFR
BUTTER	Real dairy-based butter			
MARGARINE	Blue Bonnet, Parkay, I can't believe it's not butter			
CHEESE - DAIRY BASED	Packaged cheese/cheese slices, Velveeta cheese, Tetra Lay cheese dip, Parmesan			
INFANT FORMULA - DAIRY	Enfamil, Similac			
SOY INFANT FORMULA	Prosobee, Isomil, Good Start Soy			
COCONUT MILK	Refrigerated (e.g. half gallon), Canned coconut milk			
MILK - DAIRY	Refrigerated, Nonpuls, Kids, Canned Evaporated Milk, Sweetened Condensed			
SOUR CREAM	Sour cream, refrigerated french onion dip			
YOGURT - DAIRY BASED	Yogurt, yogurt drinks, Kefir (may be in page that lists the milk)			

Variety	Tally / Count (Max count of 20)	Sold by Units, Lbs, Both	FFR

Other Dairy / Dairy Substitutes (write in on blank lines above)

GHEE	ALMOND MILK	COCONUT BASED YOGURT
ALMOND BASED CHEESE	RICE MILK	RICE BASED YOGURT
SOY-BASED CHEESE	SOY MILK	SOY BASED YOGURT

FRUITS

Variety	Common Examples	Tally / Count (Max count of 20)	Sold by Units, Lbs, Both	FFR
APPLES	100% juice, applesauce, fresh apples, apple pie filling, rainy juice			
BANANAS	Fresh bananas			
CHERRIES	Maraschino cherries, cherry pie filling			
COCONUT	Coconut cream, Flaked coconut			
CRANBERRIES	Cranberry sauce			
DATES				
GRAPEFRUIT	100% juice			
GRAPES / RAISINS	Jelly (but ingredient not sugar), raisins			
LEMONS	Fresh lemons, 100% lemon juice			
LIMES	Fresh limes, 100% lime juice			
ORANGES	Fresh oranges, 100% orange juice, canned mandarin oranges			
PEACHES	Fruit cocktail (check list ingredients)			
PEARS	Fruit cocktail (check list ingredients)			
PINEAPPLE	Canned pineapple, 100% pineapple juice (usually in cans)			

Variety	Tally / Count (Max count of 20)	Sold by Units, Lbs, Both	FFR

Other Fruits (write in on blank lines above)

APRICOTS	DRAGON FRUIT	HONEY DEW	LYCHEE	PAPAYA	POMEGRANATE
BLACKBERRIES	FIGS	JACKFRUIT	MANGOES	PERSIMMON	RASPBERRIES
BLUEBERRIES	GOJI BERRIES	KIWI	NANCE	PLANTAINS	STRAWBERRIES
CANTALOUPE	GUAVA	KUMQUATS	NECTARINES	PLUMS / PRUNES	SOURSOP

VEGETABLES

Variety	Common Examples	Tally / Count (Max count of 20)	Sold by Units, Lbs, Both	FFR
BEANS / SOY PRODUCTS	Dry/can beans, Bean dip			
CARROTS	Mixed veg, can carrots			
CORN / HOMINY	Can corn, can hominy			
CUCUMBERS / PICKLES	Pickles (sold in package)			
GREEN BEANS	Can green beans			
MUSHROOMS	Canned mushrooms, Mushroom soup			
NUTS/SEEDS	Almonds, peanuts, cashews, sunflower seeds, peanut butter			
OLIVES	Can or jar olives			
PEAS / CHICKPEAS /LENTILS	Can green peas, hummus			
PEPPERS	Any variety of fresh pepper, pickled jalapenos in jar			
POTATOES	Fresh or canned potatoes, potato soup, Frozen French Fries, Box instant potatoes			
TOMATOES	Soup, Tomato sauce, Ravioli, Spaghettios, Salsa, V8 Juice, 100% Tomato juice, Rogu			

Variety	Tally / Count (Max count of 20)	Sold by Units, Lbs, Both	FFR

Other Vegetables (write in on blank lines above)

ARTICHOKES	BROCCOLI	CHARD	JICAMA	PARSNIPS	TOMATILLOS
AVOCADOS	BRUSSELS SPROUTS	CHAYOTE	KALE	PUMPKIN	TURNIPS / TURNIP GREENS
ASPARAGUS	CABBAGE / SAUERKRAUT	COLLARD GREENS	LEEKS	RADISHES	WATER CHESTNUT
BAMBOO	CACTUS	EGGPLANT	LETTUCE	SHALLOTS	SQUASH
BOK CHOI	CAULIFLOWER	FENNEL	OKRA	SPINACH	YUCCA
BEETS	CELERY	HEARTS OF PALM	ONIONS	SWEET POTATOES / YAMS	ZUCCHINI

COUNTING STAPLE FOODS:

- FOR MULTI-INGREDIENT FOODS:
  - COUNT BASED ON 1ST INGREDIENT (ONE OF THE STAPLE FOODS LISTED ABOVE)
  - IF 1ST INGREDIENT IS WATER, BROTH, OR STOCK, COUNT BASED ON 2ND INGREDIENT
- COMMON MULTI-INGREDIENT FOODS: FROZEN DINNERS / POT PIES, SOUPS, CEREALS
- INFANT FRUITS, VEGETABLES, AND MEATS ARE COUNTED BASED ON 1ST INGREDIENT
- FOODS MAY BE FRESH, FROZEN, CANNED, DRIED, PICKLED
- IF EVEN ONE UNIT OF FOOD IN A VARIETY OF FOOD IS FFR, MARK THAT VARIETY AS FFR

NOT COUNTED AS STAPLE FOODS:

- COOKIES, CAKES, MUFFINS, PIES, BAKING MIXES USED TO MAKE THESE ITEMS
- CRACKERS OR CHIPS/INCLUDING FRUIT CHIPS
- JELLIES, JAMS WITH SUGAR AS FIRST INGREDIENT
- PUDDING, JELLO
- SPICES, CONDIMENTS (MUSTARD, MAYONNAISE, KETCHUP, PICKLE RELISH)
- DRINKS THAT ARE NOT 100% JUICE (E.g. NECTARS, SODAS, OCEAN SPRAY CRANBERRY JUICE COCKTAIL, SUNNY DELIGHT, COCONUT WATER, COCONUT "JUICE")
- ALCOHOLIC BEVERAGES OR COOKING WINE
- HEAVY CREAM
- ICE CREAM, FROZEN YOGURT, WHIPPED CREAM, SHERBET
- FOOD MADE ON-SITE, HOT FOOD, FOOD EATEN ON SITE
- FOOD SOLD UNPACKAGED (LARGE DILLY PICKLES, PICKLES EGGS OUT OF A GALLON JAR)
- ANY PRODUCT WHERE 1ST INGREDIENT IS NOT STAPLE FOOD, OR 2ND INGREDIENT IS NOT STAPLE FOOD (IF 1ST INGREDIENT IS WATER, STOCK, OR BROTH)
- CANDY
- BAKING POWDER, BAKING SODA, COOKING OIL, SUGAR, HONEY, VANILLA EXTRACT
- GRAVY OR BOUILLON
- ANY ITEM WITH A MAIN INGREDIENT IN THE ABOVE LIST

Accessory Foods

Snacks, desserts, ice cream, chips, candy, spices (more complete list in Reviewer SOP)

Beverages that are not 100% juice

SNAP/EBT-eligible but not included in staple food counts, REGARDLESS of ingredients

Other Foods Not Counted as Staple Foods

Hot foods

Cold prepared foods made ON SITE in the store

Ingredients used only to make prepared foods and not sold as-is to customers

Priority of Food Counts

Maximum Varieties to be Reported

- Dairy / Dairy Substitutes – 10 varieties
- Meats/Poultry/ Fish – 10 varieties
- Breads/Cereals – 10 varieties
- Fruits and/or Vegetables – 14 total varieties

Priority of Food Counts
Which varieties to report

- Highest food counts and FFR units are present
- Varieties with 3 or more units and FFR units are present
- Highest food counts that have no FFR units
- Varieties with less than 3 units and FFR units are present
- Varieties with less than 3 units and no FFR units

Counting and Reporting Staple Food Inventory

- All items with the same main ingredient are counted as one variety (e.g. Spaghettios, Tomato sauce, Fresh tomatoes, 100% Tomato juice are all counted as "Tomatoes")
- Maximum number of units to count per variety is 20
- Notate whether foods are sold as units, by the pound (customer selects amount to buy, not-prepackaged) or both
- If even one unit of food in a variety is FFR, check the FFR box for that variety
- All foods counted should be shown in photos and on sketch